STD 9 UNIT 4

The Unstoppable Soul Surfer
- Bethany Hamilton

1 Prepare a news report of the shark attack

Surfer Bethany Hamilton Loses Arm in Shark Attack

staff reporter

Kauai. October 31, 2003: In a shocking incident that trembled the whole world, renowned surfer Bethany Hamilton faced an encounter with a shark. The attack, which occurred on a fateful morning in 2003, left Hamilton with severe injuries, including the loss of her left arm.

13-year-old Hamilton was enjoying a morning surf along Tunnels Beach, Kauai, with her best friend Alana. While Hamilton was lying on her surfboard stomach-down, a tiger shark attacked her.It swiftly bit off Hamilton's left arm, which was dangling in the water, just below the shoulder. Alana's father fashioned a tourniquet out of a rash guard and wrapped it around the stump of her arm and Hamilton was rushed to hospital By the time she arrived there, she had lost over 60% of her blood .

The news from the hospital says she has displayed extraordinary courage and resilience. Doctors assure that she is out of danger .Her father is optimistic about his daughter's will power. Everyone prays for her safe return to the field of surfing overcoming her fate.

2.While at the hospital, Bethany tries to console herself and regain self-confidence. She decides to dream differently. She jots down her feelings and thoughts in her diary. Help her complete the diary entry.

I can't believe what happened today. It feels like a nightmare. Alana and I were just out there riding the waves. The waves were perfect, and I felt a thrill .But then in an instant everything changed. It was like a scene from a horror movie. A huge shark. I remember the shock and I lost my arm. My left arm. My surfing arm. . My friends helped me out of the water, applied pressure to my arm, and got me to the hospital. I have spent my whole life in the water. I don't know how I will ever surf again. But I won't let this defeat me. I am strong. . I Will find a way. I'm scared, but I'm also filled with hope for a return to the ocean.

3. Prepare some questions to interview Bethany

- **What were your initial thoughts and feelings immediately after the attack?**
- **What role did your faith play in your recovery and healing process?**
- **What motivated you to return to surfing after such a horrible experience?**
- **How was your first surf session after the attack?**

- What were the challenges and adjustments you had to make to your surfing style?
- What advice would you give to others who have experienced such fatal events?
- Did you ever have doubts about returning to surfing?
- What role did family, friends, and faith play in your recovery?

4 Prepare a character sketch of Bethany Hamilton

Bethany Hamilton is a professional surfer, motivational speaker and writer. She lost her arm in a shark attack when she was just 13 years old. In spite of the tragedy she learned to surf again with one arm .Her life is a powerful example of a woman's ability to adjust, adapt, and succeed in the face of adversity. Her courage to face the ocean again shows a deep-rooted determination. Just a month after the attack, she was back in the water and within two years she won her first national surfing title. Bethany has a strong spirit and a deep faith that helped her overcome the challenges..Her positive attitude and dedication have inspired the whole world.. Her message of hope and perseverance has indeed made her a true role model.

5. Imagine you read an article about Bethany Hamilton in a leading news paper. You feel highly inspired by the story and decides to send an Email to Bethany .Draft the Email.

From

sumanjohny@gamil.com

To

bethany.hamilton@gmail.com.

Dear Maa'm

I feel so proud to send you this letter to appreciate your will power and dedication. When I read an article about you in The Hindu I was really surprised .How bravely you faced the shark incident! What inspired me most is your decision to start all again ,to face the ocean, that too with one arm. We see people leaving their dreams behind whenever life challenges them . But you are an exception. A role model for the whole world.

Thank you for sharing your story with the world. Your courage continues to inspire countless others, including myself.

With sincere admiration,

6"The harder the struggle, the more glorious the victory." Prepare a write up on this topic based on the will and determination of Bethany Hamilton.

Life is like an ocean ,often throws unexpected storms. While some bury their dreams forever, there are others who rise above the waves . Bethany Hamilton, a symbol of courage and resilience, is one such inspiring figure.

A promising young surfer Bethany's life took a dramatic turn when a shark attack claimed her left arm. The incident could have shattered her dreams and spirit. Instead it ignited a fire within her. Just a month after the attack, she was back in the water and within two years she won her first national surfing title. At some point in her life she had thought about changing her dream and become a surf photographer. But her parent's support helped her to go on with her ambition until it is fulfilled.

Bethany has a strong spirit and a deep faith that helped her overcome the challenges. Her positive attitude and dedication have inspired the whole world.. Her message of hope and perseverance has indeed made her a true role model. Bethany Hamilton's journey is a reminder that true strength lies not in avoiding challenges, but in facing them .Thus we can unlock our hidden potential and emerge as stronger individuals.

7. You are planning to organise a meeting to congratulate Bethany in your school. As the convenor of English club prepare a notice

8. After the shark attack Bethany thinks about becoming a surf photographer. Her father inspires her to pursue her dream of surfing. Prepare a conversation between them

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